Reconceptualizing Shadow IT: Motivations, Consequences, and Governance in the Age of Shadow AI

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Contents

Zusammenfassung **III**

Abstract **IV**

List of Figures **V**

List of Tables **VI**

List of Abbreviations **VII**

1 Introduction **1**

2 Theoretical Foundations **1**
2.1 Shadow IT 1
2.2 Motivational Theories 1
2.3 From Shadow IT to Shadow AI 1

3 Methodology **1**
3.1 Purpose 1
3.2 Draft Protocol 2
3.3 Practical Screening 2
3.4 Literature Search 2
3.5 Data Extraction 3
3.6 Quality Appraisal 4
3.7 Study Synthesization 4
3.8 Writing the Review 4

4 Structured Literature Review Results **5**
4.1 Overview of Identified Literature 5
4.2 Motivational Factors 5
4.3 Organizational Consequences 5
4.4 Governance Approaches and Countermeasures 5

5 Conceptual Development: Extending Shadow IT to Shadow AI **5**
5.1 Transferable Motivations 5
5.2 Novel Motivations 5
5.3 Behavioral Shift in Knowledge Work 5
5.4 Integrated Conceptual Framework 5

6 Comparative Analysis of Shadow IT and Shadow AI **5**
6.1 Differences in Motivational Drivers 5
6.2 Differences in Organizational Risk 5
6.3 Differences in Governance Approaches 5

7 Discussion **5**

8 Limitations and Future Research Directions **5**

9 Conclusion **5**

Bibliography **7**

A Appendix A **8**

Zusammenfassung

Eine Kurzzusammenfassung der Vorgehensweise und der wesentlichen Ergebnisse.
Allgemeine Merkmale

- Objektivität: Es soll sich jeder persönlichen Wertung enthalten.
- Kürze: Es soll so kurz wie möglich sein.
- Verständlichkeit: Es weist eine klare, nachvollziehbare Sprache und Struktur auf.
- Vollständigkeit: Alle wesentlichen Sachverhalte sollen enthalten sein.
- Genauigkeit: Es soll genau die Inhalte und die Meinung der Originalarbeit wiedergeben.

Abstract

Obige Zusammenfassung in englischer Sprache.

List of Figures

List of Tables

1 Literature Search Strings 3
2 Database Search Results per String 3
3 Literature Screening Process 4

List of Abbreviations

AI Artificial Intelligence

SAI Shadow AI

SIT Shadow IT

SLR Structured Literature Review

1 Introduction

Dieser Teil der Arbeit sollte folgende Inhalte haben: • Einführung in die Problemstellung • Motivation und Herleitung des Themas • Aufbau der Arbeit Hinweis: Es hat sich als hilfreich erwiesen, die Einleitung mit der Zusammenfassung bzw. dem Abstract und der Schlussfolgerung zu vergleichen. Damit stellt man sicher, dass diese inhaltlich im Bezug auf Zielsetzung und Motivation übereinstimmen. Der Umfang sollte ca. 5 % der gesamten Arbeit betragen. (= ca. 2 Seiten)

Alaimo and Kallinikos (2022)

2 Theoretical Foundations

In order to establish a comprehensive understanding of Shadow IT (SIT) and its further, Shadow AI (SAI), this section provides an overview of the theoretical foundations and definitions relevant to these phenomena.

2.1 Shadow IT

2.2 Motivational Theories

2.3 From Shadow IT to Shadow AI

3 Methodology

The review follows a structured approach based on the guidelines provided by Okoli (2015, pp. 887–902) for conducting a Structured Literature Review (SLR) in the field of information systems research. The methodology is organized into four phases of two steps each: Planning, Selection, Extraction, and Execution (Okoli, 2015, p. 885).

While the original framework is designed for collaborative research settings involving multiple reviewers, this review was conducted by a single researcher. Therefore, minor adaptions were made to certain steps (e.g., drafting the research protocol, team training) to ensure methodological rigor while maintaining the integrity of the review process. The following sections describe these phases and their implementation in the context of this review.

3.1 Purpose

The first step in conducting a SLR is to define the purpose of the review, which is to identify and analyze existing literature on the phenomenon of SIT and further the development of SAI in organizational contexts. The SLR aims to synthesize insights on the motivations behind SIT and SAI, their organizational consequences, and the governance approaches employed to manage these phenomena.

3.2 Draft Protocol

The second step includes drafting a research question, a research protocol, and training the team. Since this thesis is conducted by a single person, the protocol and team training steps are not required and will therefore not be carried out further. The research questions guiding this review are as follows:

Main Research Question (RQ): How does SAI differ from traditional SIT in organizations with regard to motivational factors, consequences, and countermeasures?

To better address the research question, it will be broken down into three sub-questions and answered throughout the paper:

1. Which motivational factors known from SIT are transferable to SAI, and which additional motivation factors are specific to SAI?
2. Which organizational consequences of SAI differ from those of SIT?
3. Which countermeasures are discussed for SIT and SAI, and how do they differ in design and expected effectiveness?

3.3 Practical Screening

To make sure only relevant and high-quality literature is included in the review, practical screening criteria are defined to filter the initial search results.

- Content: Shadow IT in Organizations, Shadow AI in Organizations, Motivations for Shadow IT/AI, Organizational Consequences of Shadow IT/AI, Governance of Shadow IT/AI
- Language: English
- Time Frame: 2005 - present
- Publication Type: Journal Articles, Conference Proceedings, Books, Book Chapters/Sections
- Setting: Organizational/professional
- Participants: Professionals, managers, analysts, data scientists, IT staff, end-users
- Design: Empirical (quantitative, qualitative, mixed methods), Theoretical/Conceptual, Review

3.4 Literature Search

The literature search was conducted using four search strings across four databases (AISeL, EBSCO, IEEE, and Web of Science), employing advanced search with Boolean operators (`OR` and `AND`) applied to all fields or title/abstract/keywords depending on the database.

String S3.2 was included to capture literature that may not explicitly use the term *Shadow AI* but discusses the intersection of SIT and Artificial Intelligence (AI) technologies.

Of the 255 abstracts reviewed in full, 132 were excluded for reasons including overly

Table 1: Literature Search Strings

String	Purpose	Query
S1	Shadow IT Baseline	`"shadow IT" OR "rogue IT" OR "IT workaround" OR "feral system"`
S2	Shadow AI Baseline	`"shadow AI" OR "unauthorized AI" OR "unsanctioned AI" OR "BYOAI"`
S3.1	Shadow IT × Shadow AI	`("shadow IT" OR "rogue IT" OR "IT workaround" OR "feral system") AND ("shadow AI" OR "unauthorized AI" OR "unsanctioned AI" OR "BYOAI")`
S3.2	Shadow IT × AI (broader)	`"shadow IT" AND "artificial intelligence"`

Table 2: Database Search Results per String

String	AISeL	EBSCO	IEEE	WoS	Total
S1	296	227	39	94	656
S2	6	79	9	5	99
S3.1	4	2	0	0	6
S3.2	45	18	4	3	70
Total	**351**	**326**	**52**	**102**	**831**

broad scope, lack of organisational context, or wrongly exported reference type (e.g. newspaper declared as journal article). At the full-text stage, 60 records were included, 41 were excluded, access was requested for 10 records, and 12 remained inaccessible.

3.5 Data Extraction

The remaining literature was subjected to a systematic data extraction process, where the literature was coded and sorted based on their key scope in accordance to the research questions. Based on this preliminary coding, relevant information was extracted and collected in a structured format to group similar concepts and themes together. This process was conducted iteratively, with multiple rounds of coding and extraction to ensure that all relevant information was captured and organized effectively for further analysis and synthesis in the subsequent phases of the review.

3.6 Quality Appraisal

While the practical screening criteria help filter out irrelevant studies before even reading the full text, the review process also involves a quality appraisal to ensure the included studies meet certain standards. Therefore exclusion criteria need to be defined and applied to the extracted studies (Okoli, 2015, p. 884).

This SLR excluded studies with unsufficient theoretical contribution, unclear methodology or findings, or low prerequisites to adequately answer the research questions. After applying the prior steps and the exclusion criteria, Table 3 summarizes the final set of included studies for the review:

Table 3: Literature Screening Process

Stage	**Included**	**Excluded**	**Remaining**
Records identified	–	–	831
After duplicate removal	–	124	707
Practical screening			
Language (English only)	–	23	684
Publication year (2005–present)	–	30	654
Publication type	–	15	639
Content screening			
Title screening	255	384	255
Abstract screening	123	132	123
Full-text review			
Not accessible	–	20	–
Final literature corpus	62	41	62

3.7 Study Synthesization

Study synthesization involves aggregating, summarizing, and interpreting the findings from the included studies to answer the research questions (Okoli, 2015, p. 899).

3.8 Writing the Review

Execution - Explicit + Reproducible

4 Structured Literature Review Results

4.1 Overview of Identified Literature

4.2 Motivational Factors

Reports findings separately for SIT and SAI, but does not deeply interpret them.

4.3 Organizational Consequences

4.4 Governance Approaches and Countermeasures

5 Conceptual Development: Extending Shadow IT to Shadow AI

5.1 Transferable Motivations

5.2 Novel Motivations

5.3 Behavioral Shift in Knowledge Work

5.4 Integrated Conceptual Framework

6 Comparative Analysis of Shadow IT and Shadow AI

6.1 Differences in Motivational Drivers

6.2 Differences in Organizational Risk

6.3 Differences in Governance Approaches

7 Discussion

8 Limitations and Future Research Directions

9 Conclusion

In der Schlussfolgerung sollen

• die Themenstellung • der gewählte Ansatz • die Ergebnisse der Arbeit • eine kritische Stellungnahme/Einschätzung • nächste Schritte

deutlich werden. Hinweis: Die Schlussfolgerung sollte mit der Zusammenfassung bzw. dem Abstract und der Einleitung abgeglichen werden. Es sollte immer eine Zusammenfassung der wesentlichen Erkenntnisse der eigenen Arbeit sein, die den Forschungs-

beitrag darstellt. Der Umfang der Schlussfolgerung sollte ähnlich wie die Einleitung ca. 5 % der gesamten Arbeit betragen. (= ca. 2 Seiten)

References

Alaimo, Cristina and Jannis Kallinikos (2022). "Organizations Decenterded: Data Objects, Technology and Knowledge." In: *Organization Science* 33.1, pp. 19–37.

Okoli, Chitu (2015). "A Guide to Conducting a Standalone Systematic Literature Review". In: *Communications of the Association for Information Systems* 37, pp. 879–910.

A Appendix A